

Apple iPod 30GB

Hard drive-based MP3 players are the most expensive type, but they also provide the maximum storage space and a plethora of features.

Weighing 176 gms, the Apple iPod sports a plain white front panel, with a stainless steel finished back. It has a 2-inch backlit LCD on the front panel. The front panel also features a rotary wheel and five buttons to control the player—all touch-sensitive. Apart from the 30 GB model we tested, the Apple iPod is also available in 10 GB and 15 GB storage capacities. The 25-minute skip protection ensures that the iPod is the perfect jogging companion. A FireWire (IEEE1394) cable connects directly to the iPod or to the included docking cradle. iTunes and MusicMatch software are provided on a CD for both Mac and Windows users.

The 30 GB hard drive can store approximately 7,500 songs, at 4 minutes per song encoded at 128 Kbps MP3 or AAC formats. You can browse by playlist, album, artist, composer, genre or song. The main menu can be customised, and so can the backlight time and the screen contrast.

You can also use the device as a portable hard drive to transfer any kind of data between different computers. There is also a Line-Out socket that lets you connect your iPod to a stereo system.

The iPod supports MP3, MP3 Variable Bit Rate, AAC, WAV, AA, and AIFF audio file formats. The provided earphones produce crystal clear music at 30 mW per channel for an immersive experience.

We transferred 1 GB of songs, using USB 2.0 from a PC running Windows XP and MusicMatch software, in just about 6 minutes and 25 seconds. The internal lithium-ion battery takes about an hour to charge up to 80 per cent and about 3 to 4 hours to charge fully, it lasts for about 6 hours.

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Price: Rs 45,000 for 30 GB,
Rs 36,000 for 15 GB and
Rs 28,000 for 10 GB



Apple iPod 30 GB	B
Performance	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Features	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Value for money	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Ease of use	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶

playlist, but can create folders in the removable drive. Note that all the songs inside the folders are listed along with those stored in the root. Though the manufacturer claims that the single AAA battery will last 12 hours, it gave us only 4.5 hours of continuous playback.

The jog switch lets you switch between music and voice modes, and customise other settings.

You can choose between five equaliser modes, but there is no user defined equaliser setting possible. You can repeat and shuffle tracks in playback mode, and customise the backlight and power off timings. You can also choose between 16 KHz and 44.1 KHz bit rates for voice recording.



1/2 page V AD